Iliya Forsati

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Research Interests

Trustworthy and secure machine learning, with a focus on large language models: backdoor attacks and defenses, trigger inversion, adversarial robustness, jailbreak attacks and safety alignment, red-teaming, and the security of LLM-based agents.

Education

Sharif University of Technology Sep 2023 – Jun 2028 (expected)
B.Sc. in Computer Engineering *Tehran, Iran*

GPA: 18.35/20 overall (department average: 17.49/20) · 18.93/20 major · 19.28/20 in AI-related courses

AI-Related Coursework

Artificial Intelligence	**20.0**	Engineering Probability and Statistics	**20.0**
Machine Learning	**19.2**	Linear Algebra	**17.0**
Design of Algorithms	**20.0**	Data Structures and Algorithms	**19.5**

In progress (Fall 2026): Security and Privacy of Machine Learning *(graduate course)*

Research Experience

RIML Lab, Sharif University of Technology May 2026 – present
Undergraduate Researcher, advised by Dr. Mohammad Hossein Rohban *Tehran, Iran*

- Developing a search-based method that detects backdoored LLMs and recovers both the *trigger* and the attacker's *target*, using only the model's output distribution.
- Evaluated on 128 models (TrojAI, the BAIT model zoo, and a harder set of stealthily poisoned models); matches or outperforms BAIT (Shen et al., IEEE S&P 2025) on all sets and, unlike BAIT, also recovers the trigger.
- Contribute to method design, implementation, and experiments, and review related work to compare against prior scanners, working closely with senior graduate students in the lab.

Publications

Black-Box Backdoor Scanning and Trigger Inversion for Large Language Models (working title). With M. H. Rohban and members of the RIML Lab. *Work in progress; planned submission to ICML 2027.*

Teaching Experience

Artificial Intelligence | *Teaching Assistant, 4 course offerings* Spring 2026 – Fall 2026
Instructors: Dr. A. Marioriyad; Dr. M. Soleymani; Dr. E. Tanghatari; Dr. A. Marioriyad and Dr. M. Fereydooni (co-taught)

- Responsible for designing the practical and theoretical assignments.

Machine Learning | *Teaching Assistant, 3 course offerings* Spring 2026 – Fall 2026
Instructors: Dr. A. Motahari; Dr. M. Soleymani; Dr. A. Marioriyad

- Responsible for designing the practical assignments.

Fundamentals & Advanced Programming | *Head TA and TA, 3 course offerings* Spring 2025 – Fall 2025
Instructors: Dr. Zarei; Dr. Sadri; Dr. Najimi

- As head TA, led the TA team and designed the programming projects for more than 100 first-year students.

Honors

Iranian University Entrance Exam (2023): ranked **32nd** nationally (21st in quota region) among more than 150,000 participants in the Mathematics and Physics track.

Skills

Machine Learning	PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, PEFT/LoRA, vLLM, scikit-learn
Programming	Python, C/C++, SQL, Linux, Git, Docker, Kubernetes
Languages	Persian (native), English (fluent)

References

Dr. M. H. Rohban	Department of Computer Engineering, Sharif University of Technology · rohban@sharif.edu
Dr. M. A. Abam	Department of Computer Engineering, Sharif University of Technology · abam@sharif.edu
Hossein Mirzaei	EPFL, Switzerland · hossein.mirzaeisadeghlou@epfl.ch